

Vacation Preparation Checklist

CHECKLIST

Leave with confidence; return to a ready home

Use this checklist the week before you leave. Aim for a home that looks occupied, has a trusted contact, and is ready for your return.

Trip details

LEAVE DATE / RETURN DATE

DESTINATION

LODGING NAME / PHONE

TRANSPORTATION

Before you leave: notify

- ☐ Trusted local contact knows your dates and has a key or access code.
- ☐ Backup contact is named in case the first is unavailable.
- ☐ Alarm company and/or property manager notified, as appropriate.
- ☐ Emergency contact and key instructions written down below.
- ☐ Mail and newspaper held or collected; deliveries paused.

**Consider submitting a Vacation Watch Request** before leaving town, where your local law-enforcement agency offers one. Include your dates, contacts, and any vehicles or people expected at the home.

Home readiness

- ☐ All doors, windows, garage, and gates locked; sliding doors barred.
- ☐ Lights on timers in two or more rooms; vary the on/off times.
- ☐ Trash out and cans brought in (or a neighbor will handle it).
- ☐ Perishables removed; dishwasher and laundry finished.
- ☐ Thermostat set; water heater on vacation mode if available.
- ☐ Water supply shut off or washer hoses checked for leaks.
- ☐ Unneeded electronics unplugged; chargers and heaters off.

Security and privacy

- ☐ Do not announce travel dates or post trip photos until you return.
- ☐ Valuables, spare keys, and important documents secured.
- ☐ Alarm, cameras, and smart locks tested; app notifications on.
- ☐ Lawn, snow, and driveway covered so the home looks occupied.

Pet care

- ☐ Sitter or boarding confirmed; food, medication, and schedule written down.
- ☐ Veterinarian name, phone, and authorization for care left with caregiver.

Trusted contacts and access worksheet Give a copy to your trusted local contact

Contact / role	Name	Phone	Key, access, or special instructions
Trusted local contact			
Backup contact			
Emergency contact			
Pet caregiver / veterinarian			
Alarm company / property manager			
Lodging / travel company			
Other			